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How to build a simple REST API in PHP

10m



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There are a series of steps required to run a simple REST API using PHP. REST API can be run either on a WAMP or XAMPP server.

Remember to make sure that you have launched your WAMP and Apache web server.

Step 1: Go to the location where your WAMP server is installed. Create the REST API folder inside the www/Projects folder of the WAMP server. Open your chosen code editor and navigate to this folder.

Step 2: Next, inside the REST API folder, create a new directory called **server**. Make a directory inside of this one called API, then inside of that directory, make a file called hello.php. You will write the routes in this file. Copy and paste the following code there:

 Copy

```
1  <?php header( "Access-Control-Allow-Origin: * ");
2  // get request method
3  $method = $_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'];
4  if ($method == 'GET')
5  { echo "THIS IS A GET REQUEST "; }
6  if ($method == 'POST')
7  { echo "THIS IS A POST REQUEST "; }
8  if ($method == 'PUT')
9  { echo "THIS IS A PUT REQUEST "; }
10 if ($method == 'DELETE')
11 { echo "THIS IS A DELETE REQUEST "; }
```

gistfile1.txt hosted with ❤ by GitHub

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If you're using a XAMPP server, please create the REST API folder REST-API inside the htdocs directory.

Step 3: Run the code through your WAMP server and navigate your browser to the `hello.php` file. You will see a message that says 'This is a GET Request' because the browser's address bar is used to call an API, so the GET request is now being processed.

That's basically it! You now understand how to build a basic REST API in PHP.

Dig deeper

For a more enhanced version of REST API with routing, read *URL Routing* (Web Reference, n.d.), which wraps a RESTful API and URL routing within a PHP class.



Thoughts on this page?

